

1. Executive Summary

Project Lighthouse is Meridian Analytics' strategic initiative to expand into the enterprise healthcare market, targeting large hospital systems, healthcare networks, and health-tech organizations.

The initiative is designed to position Meridian as a trusted analytics and decision intelligence platform for healthcare organizations navigating increasing complexity in data, compliance, and operational efficiency.

This expansion represents a significant growth opportunity, with healthcare analytics projected to be one of the fastest-growing segments within the broader data and analytics market. However, success will require focused investment in compliance, domain-specific capabilities, and enterprise sales motion.

2. Business Case

Market Opportunity

- Healthcare analytics market estimated at \$25B+ globally, growing at ~12–15% CAGR
 - Increasing demand driven by:
 - Regulatory requirements (HIPAA, data governance)
 - Need for cost optimization and operational efficiency
 - Growth in electronic health records (EHR) and fragmented data systems
 - Shift toward value-based care models
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Strategic Rationale

1. High-Value Customer Segment

- Enterprise healthcare customers have large contract sizes (ACV \$150K–\$500K+)
- Long-term retention due to high switching costs

2. Strong Fit for Meridian's Capabilities

- Data integration across siloed systems aligns with healthcare needs
- Embedded analytics supports internal tools and clinician workflows
- Opportunity to layer AI-driven insights (e.g., patient trends, operational forecasting)

3. Competitive Differentiation Opportunity

- Many incumbents are legacy systems with poor UX
- Opportunity to position Meridian as:

- Faster to deploy
 - More flexible
 - More user-friendly
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Revenue Impact (3-Year Outlook)

- Year 1: Pilot + early enterprise wins (\$1–3M ARR)
 - Year 2: Expansion within accounts + new logos (\$5–10M ARR)
 - Year 3: Scaled vertical offering (\$15M+ ARR potential)
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3. Success Metrics

Commercial Metrics

- Enterprise Healthcare ARR
 - Average Contract Value (ACV)
 - Pipeline generated in healthcare vertical
 - Win rate vs. competitors
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Product & Adoption Metrics

- Time-to-deployment for healthcare customers
 - Active users within healthcare accounts
 - Feature adoption (especially compliance + AI features)
 - Customer retention and expansion rates
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Operational Metrics

- Sales cycle length (target: reduction over time)
 - Implementation timeline adherence
 - Customer satisfaction (NPS / CSAT)
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Milestone Targets

- Q2: First 2–3 pilot customers signed
 - Q3: Initial healthcare-specific product features launched
 - Q4: Repeatable GTM motion established
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4. Strategic Approach

Phase 1: Market Entry (0–3 Months)

- Identify target accounts (top 50 enterprise healthcare organizations)
 - Develop healthcare-specific messaging and positioning
 - Launch pilot program with design partners
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Phase 2: Product Adaptation (3–9 Months)

- Build healthcare-specific capabilities:
 - Compliance (HIPAA readiness, audit logs)
 - Data models for healthcare use cases
 - Pre-built dashboards (clinical, operational, financial)
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Phase 3: Scale & Expansion (9–18 Months)

- Formalize healthcare vertical offering
 - Expand sales team specialization
 - Develop case studies and reference customers
 - Optimize onboarding and deployment processes
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5. Key Risks & Mitigations

Risk 1: Regulatory & Compliance Complexity

Challenge:

Healthcare requires strict compliance (HIPAA, data security, auditability)

Mitigation:

- Invest in compliance infrastructure early
 - Engage legal and security teams from Day 1
 - Pursue certifications where applicable
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Risk 2: Long Enterprise Sales Cycles

Challenge:

Healthcare deals may take 6–12+ months to close

Mitigation:

- Focus on pilot programs to accelerate entry
 - Build strong ROI narratives
 - Leverage executive relationships
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Risk 3: Product Gaps for Healthcare Use Cases

Challenge:

Current product may not fully meet healthcare-specific needs

Mitigation:

- Co-develop features with pilot customers
- Prioritize highest-impact use cases first
- Maintain flexible, modular architecture

Risk 4: Competitive Pressure from Specialized Vendors

Challenge:

Existing healthcare analytics vendors have domain expertise

Mitigation:

- Differentiate on UX, speed, and flexibility
- Hire domain experts (healthcare SMEs)
- Build targeted messaging and case studies

Risk 5: Resource Dilution

Challenge:

Expansion may divert focus from core business

Mitigation:

- Create dedicated Lighthouse team
- Set clear success thresholds for continued investment
- Maintain core roadmap discipline

6. Timeline & Milestones

Q2 (Initiation Phase)

- Finalize initiative scope and resourcing
- Identify and engage pilot customers
- Define healthcare product requirements
- Launch initial GTM messaging

Q3 (Build & Validate Phase)

- Release first healthcare-specific features
- Close initial enterprise deals
- Gather customer feedback and iterate
- Begin building case studies

Q4 (Scale Phase)

- Expand pipeline and sales efforts
- Refine onboarding and deployment processes
- Increase marketing investment in healthcare vertical
- Evaluate performance vs. targets

Year 2+

- Scale dedicated healthcare business unit
 - Expand into adjacent segments (payer, pharma, etc.)
 - Mature product offering and integrations
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7. Resource Requirements

Headcount

Product & Engineering

- 1 Product Manager (Healthcare vertical)
- 4–6 Engineers (compliance, integrations, features)
- 1 UX Designer (healthcare workflows)

Go-To-Market (GTM)

- 2 Enterprise Account Executives (healthcare-focused)
- 1 Sales Engineer
- 1 Marketing Lead (vertical-specific)

Customer Success

- 1–2 Implementation Specialists
 - 1 Customer Success Manager (enterprise healthcare)
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Budget

- Product development (engineering + tooling)
 - Compliance and security investments
 - Marketing (events, content, demand generation)
 - Sales enablement and training
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Technology & Infrastructure

- Enhanced data security and access controls
 - Audit logging and compliance tooling
 - Scalable infrastructure for enterprise workloads
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8. Governance & Ownership

- Executive Sponsor: CEO / CRO
- Initiative Lead: VP Strategy & Ops
- Product Owner: CPO / Healthcare PM
- GTM Owner: CRO / Sales Leadership

Reporting Cadence:

- Bi-weekly initiative review
 - Monthly executive update
 - Quarterly performance evaluation
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9. Decision Framework

Continuation and scaling of Project Lighthouse will be evaluated based on:

- Achievement of pilot success metrics
- Pipeline and revenue traction
- Product-market fit within healthcare segment
- ROI on invested resources

10. Conclusion

Project Lighthouse represents a high-potential expansion opportunity for Meridian Analytics, enabling entry into a large, growing, and defensible market.

Success will depend on:

- Focused execution
- Early customer validation
- Investment in compliance and domain expertise
- Alignment across product, GTM, and operations

If executed effectively, this initiative can establish Meridian as a trusted analytics platform in enterprise healthcare and unlock meaningful long-term growth.

End of Brief